

Yushao Ye

NHH Norwegian School of Economics
Department of Economics
Helleveien 30, 5045 Bergen
Norway

Email: yushao.ye@nhh.no
Homepage: yushao-ye.github.io
LinkedIn: [ye-yushao](https://www.linkedin.com/in/ye-yushao)
Phone: +47 55 95 99 64

Education

NHH Norwegian School of Economics

2023 – Present

PhD in Economics

Supervisor: Øivind A. Nilsen.

Visiting PhD student, University of Oxford (Michaelmas and Hilary terms, 2026–2027).

University College London (UCL)

2021 – 2022

MSc in Economics (Distinction)

Dissertation: *Employer Learning and Statistical Discrimination: Evidence from China*, supervised by Christian Dustmann. Modules: Microeconomics, Macroeconomics, Microeconometrics, Labor Economics, and Health Economics.

Maastricht University

2018 – 2021

BSc in Economics (Honours)

Bachelor thesis: *Differences in Educational Expectations Because of COVID-19*, supervised by Trudie Schils. Modules: Economics, Finance, Management, Marketing, Mathematics, and Operations.

Research Interests

Labor Economics, Applied Microeconomics,
Economics of Children and Families, Economics of Education

Work in Progress

The Intergenerational Costs of Family Migration

Couples often relocate for career reasons, and joint moves are known to raise men's earnings far more than women's. This paper asks how such moves affect the children who move with them. Using Norwegian register data, I match 137,966 couples who undertake a joint within-country move to their five nearest observationally identical non-mover couples and trace children's adult outcomes as a function of the child's age at the time of the move. Moving lowers children's educational attainment and adult income, and the cost rises steeply with the age at which the child moves: children who move between ages 11 and 16 are 8.1 percentage points less likely to complete college and rank 4.7 percentiles lower in their birth cohort's income distribution at age 30, whereas the losses of children who move before school age are several times smaller. Two natural mechanisms fail to explain the cost: moves to *better* neighborhoods are no less harmful than moves to worse ones, and moves that disrupt the mother's career are no more harmful than moves that favor her. The intergenerational cost of family migration thus appears to be a direct disruption cost borne by the child—a cost that standard household calculations of the returns to moving omit.

Spillover Effects of Public Childcare on Firms with Astrid Kunze

This study examines whether the expansion of publicly provided childcare affects firms' labour demand and performance. Using Norwegian register data, we follow public and private sector firms around the 2002 Childcare Act, which increased childcare coverage for 1–2-year-olds from 40 % in 2002 to universal coverage by 2008. We estimate intention-to-treat effects using a firm-level event-study difference-in-differences design that exploits the quasi-random rollout

across all municipalities. The results indicate positive demand-side responses: firms increase hiring and experience higher employment growth following the expansion. Moreover, firms shift their workforce composition, hiring relatively younger and more highly educated workers. We also find improvements in operational performance, suggesting that childcare expansion can affect firms not only through labour supply but also through productivity-related channels. The effects are more pronounced for the private sector.

Gender Composition in High-Stakes Exams and Educational Sorting with Catalina Franco and Marcela Gomez-Ruiz

Women now outperform men in many educational outcomes, yet remain underrepresented in selective tracks and high-return fields. This paper studies whether the gender composition of a high-stakes testing environment affects exam performance and educational choices. We use administrative data from 52,000 applicants to Colombia's top public university, where random assignment to exam rooms generates exogenous variation in the female share. A one-SD increase in the female share raises women's scores by 1.55 % of a SD, with no effect on men's overall performance. It also reduces applications to health majors for both women and men, and increases women's admissions, with gains concentrated in arts majors. Survey evidence shows no effect on stress, exam-related worries, or perceived exam difficulty. Instead, the pattern is consistent with applicants using the gender composition of the exam room to infer the competitive environment they face. These findings highlight that, even without peer interaction, temporary social cues in high-stakes settings can translate into consequential differences in performance, field sorting, and access to future opportunities.

Teaching Experience

2026: Econometrics (MSc level, NHH)

2024 – 2025: The Economics of Petroleum and the Energy Transition (MSc level, NHH);
Macroeconomics (MSc level, NHH)

Presentations at Workshops and Conferences

2026: 5th Gender and Economics Workshop (Luxembourg);
8th Annual Conference of the Baltic Economic Association (Riga, Latvia);
Royal Economic Society Annual Conference (Newcastle, UK)*;
10th International PhD Meeting in Economics (Thessaloniki, Greece)*

2025: Family Policy, Careers and Workplace Technology Workshop (Oslo, Norway);
47th Meeting of the Norwegian Association of Economists (Bergen, Norway)

* Scheduled.

Grants and Awards

2026: Research stipend, Prof. Wilhelm Keilhaus Minnefond

Additional Training

2024: Demand and Supply in Labor Markets (Magne Mogstad, University of Oslo);
Micro-econometrics (Jeffrey Wooldridge, Barcelona School of Economics);
Labor Market Adjustment to Economic Shocks (Jan Stuhler, University of Bergen)

Skills

- **Software:** Stata (advanced), L^AT_EX (advanced), R (basic)
- **Languages:** Chinese (native), English (fluent), Norwegian (basic)
- **Right to work:** China (national), Norway (permanent resident)

References

Astrid Kunze

Professor of Economics

NHH Norwegian School of Economics

Helleveien 30, 5045 Bergen, Norway

Email: astrid.kunze@nhh.no

Phone: +47 55 95 97 54

Øivind A. Nilsen

Professor of Economics

NHH Norwegian School of Economics

Helleveien 30, 5045 Bergen, Norway

Email: oivind.nilsen@nhh.no

Phone: +47 55 95 92 81

Last updated: July 2026